

» FROM THE
WORLD OF FOOTBALL

WINDS OF CHANGE

From marquee signings to managerial changes, the summer transfer market has **redrawn** the landscape across Europe's top leagues.

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Fold up your national flags and jerseys, and let them hibernate on the shelf for another four years. In the meantime, club football is back with fresh narratives, perhaps even fresher than the players themselves.

The transfer market has been busy, with the winds of change blowing both on the pitch as well as the sidelines. And with the FIFA World Cup shedding more light on several new faces, teams have been scurrying to get their combinations right ahead of what promises to be a hectic season.

Premier League

The English top tier is undoubtedly entering an era of transition, with nine of the 20 teams beginning the new season with a fresh face on the sidelines. In fact, of the informally created 'Big Six', five will have managers taking over the reins for a full season for the very first time, with reigning champion Arsenal's Mikel Arteta the only exception.

The Gunners ended a 22-year drought for the English crown last season, and judging by the summer moves, the aim seems to be to get the next one significantly quicker. Leandro Trossard's allegiance switch to Besiktas has opened up space for Greek forward Christos Tzolis to come in from Club Brugge, but Arsenal's biggest nab of the summer came from the north of England.

Newcastle United, despite its reluctance, was forced to let go of its captain, Bruno Guimaraes, who joins a midfield that is already filled to the brim with quality, with Declan Rice, Martin Zubimendi and Martin

Top draw: Bruno Guimaraes joins an Arsenal midfield that is already filled to the brim with quality, with Declan Rice, Martin Zubimendi and Martin Odegaard. REUTERS